

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

Date	23 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9408
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Customer Problem Statement Template:

A well-articulated problem statement helps the team see the challenge from the customer's point of view, using a simple structure: who they are, what they are trying to do, what gets in their way, why that barrier exists, and how it makes them feel.

Framework:

Element	Guiding Question	Answer
I am	Describe the customer with 3–4 key characteristics — who are they?	A new employee (or replacement case) who needs a standard laptop, depends on IT to set it up, wants to start work quickly, and can't see what's happening with the request (PS-1). Also the IT Hardware support team member (PS-2) and IT procurement team member (PS-3) who handle it.
I'm trying to	What outcome or "job" are they trying to achieve?	Get a standard laptop approved, configured and delivered quickly so I can start work (PS-1); configure and dispatch every approved laptop as soon as possible (PS-2); move requests smoothly from approval to configuration (PS-3).
but	What problems or barriers stand in their way?	I often wait days without any update (PS-1); I only learn about an approved request days later (PS-2); I have to manually track and follow up on every request (PS-3).
because	What is the root cause of that problem or barrier?	The catalog request has no automatic link to a Hardware team task. Creating and assigning that task depends on someone remembering to notify the team manually.
which makes me feel	What emotions result from experiencing the problem?	Frustrated and unsure who to follow up with (PS-1); reactive and overloaded (PS-2); stretched thin and worried that requests will slip through the cracks (PS-3).

Problem Statements for This Project

Three personas are affected by the current manual laptop procurement process. Their problem statements are captured below:

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	a new employee joining the company	get my standard laptop configured and ready so I can start work immediately	I often wait several days without any update on my request	there's no automatic link between my approved request and a configuration task for the Hardware team	frustrated, unproductive, and unsure who to follow up with
PS-2	a member of the IT Hardware support team	configure and dispatch every approved standard laptop request as soon as possible	I usually only learn about a new approved request through an email or verbal handoff, days later	the procurement process has no automated task creation or assignment step when a request is approved	reactive and overloaded, since delays pile up before I even know a task exists
PS-3	a member of the IT procurement team	move standard laptop requests smoothly from approval through to hardware configuration	I have to manually track and follow up on every request to make sure a hardware task actually gets created	the current process has no workflow automation connecting the catalog request to a task	stretched thin and worried that requests will slip through the cracks